

EDUCATION

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Nanjing University                                                                | Nanjing, China |
| M.A. in Journalism and Communication, specializing in Computational Communication | 2024 – 2027    |
| GPA: 4.00/4.00                                                                    |                |
| Communication University of China                                                 | Beijing, China |
| B.Eng. in Cyberspace Security, Minor in Computational Communication               | 2020 – 2024    |
| GPA: 3.64/4.00                                                                    |                |

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[2] **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2026). Depressive symptom trajectories around the retirement transition across countries and historical periods [Stage 2 Registered Report]. PsyArXiv. [https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/6ypwr\\_v6](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/6ypwr_v6). (Peer-reviewed and recommended by *Peer Community in Registered Reports*)

[1] **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2025). Depression trajectories from mid to late life (50–89 Years): The roles of cohort, multimorbidity status, and national contexts across nine European countries. *Social Science & Medicine*, 385, 118605.

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

[4] **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2026). Psychometric comparability of LLM-based digital twins. SSRN. <https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5967255>. (Revise and resubmit at *Nature Communications*)

[3] **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2026). Loneliness from midlife to older adulthood reflects both stable trait and changing circumstance. PsyArXiv. [https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/7fc9v\\_v1](https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/7fc9v_v1)

[2] **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2026). Digital exclusion among middle-aged and older adults in China: Age–period–cohort evidence from three national surveys, 2011–2022. PsyArXiv. [https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/hpv68\\_v1](https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/hpv68_v1)

[1] Yang, Y., **Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z.** (2026). Early identification of adolescent mental health risk through integrated game-based assessment and large language model psychological inference. (Under review at *The British Journal of Social Work*) Contribution: [Data curation; Formal analysis; Methodology].

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                                                                                         |                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Computational Communication Collaboratory, Nanjing University</b>                                                                                                                    | Nanjing, China    |
| Graduate Student Researcher   Supervisor: Dr. Zhihao Ma                                                                                                                                 | 2024–Present      |
| <b><i>Psychological Adaptation and Social Participation Across the Later Life Course</i></b>                                                                                            | Sep. 2024–Present |
| Investigated how aging, birth cohorts, retirement transitions, and national contexts shape depression and loneliness using large-scale longitudinal and cross-national surveys.         |                   |
| Examined digital exclusion and reciprocal associations between internet use and mental health, with attention to socioeconomic and health inequalities.                                 |                   |
| Applied advanced longitudinal and latent-variable methods, including HAPC growth-curve models, piecewise multilevel models, trait–state–occasion models, mixture modeling, and RI-CLPM. |                   |
| <b><i>Digital Twin Psychometrics</i></b>                                                                                                                                                | Aug. 2025–Present |
| Examined psychometric comparability between LLM-based digital twins and human respondents across psychological, behavioral, and free-text tasks.                                        |                   |
| Designed multi-study evaluations using large-scale survey and longitudinal datasets across models and prompting conditions.                                                             |                   |
| Applied psychometric network analysis, statistical calibration, semantic network analysis, and                                                                                          |                   |

computational text analysis to assess construct validity and human–LLM alignment.

**Constructing Old Age: A Cross-National Diachronic Analysis of Aging Narratives** Oct. 2025–Present  
Analyzed narratives of aging across countries and historical periods using large-scale textual corpora.  
Constructed diachronic word embeddings to examine age-related stereotypes and social representations of aging.  
Applied semantic association analysis, time-series analysis, and multilevel modeling to identify temporal shifts, cross-national differences, and contextual factors shaping aging narratives.

**PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PAPERS**

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- [2] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2026). Associations Between Digital Exclusion and Mental Health in Middle-Aged and Older Adults. *76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa, June 4–8, 2026. Accepted for presentation.
- [1] Zhang, Y., & Ma, Z. (2025). Tracing Digital Exclusion from Mid to Late Life in China: An Age-Period-Cohort Analysis of Socioeconomic, Regional, and Health-related Disparities, 2010–2022. *111th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA)*, Denver, CO, United States, November 20–23, 2025. Accepted for presentation.

**TEACHING AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

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**Teaching Assistant**, Nanjing University

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Computational Communication Research Training Program (Graduate course) | Fall 2026            |
| Causal Inference (Graduate course)                                      | Spring 2026          |
| Applications of LLMs in Digital Humanities (Undergraduate course)       | Spring 2026          |
| Social Research Methods (Undergraduate course)                          | Fall 2025, Fall 2026 |

**Reporting Intern**, Hong Kong, Macao and Taiwan News Desk, Xinhua News Agency May–Aug 2023

**SELECTED HONORS & AWARDS**

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|--------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Outstanding Graduate Student Award         | Dec. 2025 |
| National Scholarship for Graduate Students | Nov. 2025 |
| First Prize, Academic Scholarship          | Nov. 2025 |
| Second Prize, Academic Scholarship         | Dec. 2024 |

**GRANTS**

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| Distinguished Talent Cultivation Program (2025GYB18) ¥6,000, PI                     | Nov. 2025 |
| Project title: Determinants of Digital Exclusion Among Middle-aged and Older Adults |           |

**LANGUAGES & SKILLS**

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